

Samer's Journey to the Old Village

Samer lived in a large city, but he loved listening to his grandfather's stories about the village where he was born. The village was nestled between two mountains, near a small stream known as the Willow River. His grandfather told him that the village had once been an important trading hub where travelers would stop before crossing the mountains.

One summer day, Samer decided to visit the village himself. He took a bus in the morning and, after three hours, arrived at a small town located a few kilometers away from the village. There, he met an elderly man named Hassan, who knew the area well, having lived there his entire life.

Hassan warned Samer against using the main road because a wooden bridge over the Willow River had been damaged by heavy rains. Instead, he suggested a longer route that wound through the forest and then climbed the hill overlooking the village.

Samer thanked the man and followed the path he had described. After walking for two hours, he reached the forest. It was quiet, but he noticed the path becoming narrow and difficult to navigate. Shortly after, he encountered a large tree that had fallen across the road, blocking his way.

Samer remembered Hassan mentioning an old trail used by shepherds to reach the hill. He searched among the trees until he found it, then continued his journey. Just before sunset, he reached the top of the hill; from there, he could see the village, the river, and the damaged wooden bridge.

In the village, Samer met a woman named Laila who worked at the old library. She told him that the library housed records dating back more than a century. Interested in the village's history, Samer spent the evening reading through the records.

In one of the records, he discovered the story of a massive flood that had occurred seventy years earlier. The flood destroyed part of the old market, but the library remained intact because it was built on high ground. Samer also discovered an old map showing that the river had once been much wider than it is today.

The next morning, Samer decided to return to the city. Laila offered to drive him to town, but he declined, preferring to retrace the route he had originally taken. Before he left, she gave him a copy of the old map, asking him to return it to the library should he decide to publish a story about the village.

Upon arriving in town, Samer met Hassan again. He told him about the fallen tree in the forest and the map he had found in the library. Hassan smiled and explained that the old path Samer had discovered had been used by shepherds decades ago, and that many locals were no longer aware of its existence.

Samer returned to his city with the map and his notes. Several weeks later, he wrote an article about the village's history but did not publish the original map, out of respect for Laila's request. Instead, he described its contents and noted that the original was preserved in the village library.